AgenticRotation: Learning Local Control for Asynchronous Visual Agents in Semantic In-Hand Reorientation

Anonymous CVPR submission

Abstract

A visual agent can identify the object face requested by a user, but a dexterous hand must maintain contact while that decision is being computed. We study semantic in-hand reorientation with asynchronous visual reasoning and continuous physical execution. AgenticRotation connects a visual agent to a pose-conditioned recurrent student through a common semantic goal representation. Lightweight local controllers adapt joint targets during pending requests and subsequent execution, using measured state and public request history. Privileged teacher actions provide training supervision without entering deployment. On a marked cube with 40 matched trials per system, the latest full Astra system achieves 87.5% autonomous semantic success, compared with 75.0% for a bare fine-tuned VLM and 42.5% for a bare rule VLM. A separate waiting-controller comparison improves observed success from 69.2% to 84.6% and reduces drops from ten to five. Feedback raises completion from 17.9% with one initial plan to 76.9% with up to six calls. Under a controlled letter–color remapping, Astra retains 32/40 successes while the fine-tuned model falls from 30/40 to 16/40. The main Astra–fine-tuned difference and waiting improvement are not statistically resolved, and explicit controller-goal conditioning shows no benefit. ***[TODO: Add multi-object, improved-predictor, and physical-hand results.]***

1. Introduction

A command such as "turn the face marked T upward" specifies a visual relation, not a sequence of joint targets. A robot must locate the mark, associate it with a controllable orientation, and move the object without losing it. The requested face may initially be hidden by the object itself or by the fingers. Moving to obtain evidence changes both visibility and contact. This coupling makes in-hand reorientation a useful setting for studying visual agents that act through physical feedback.

Large visual models provide a flexible interface between an instruction and an action. Their inference time introduces another problem. The hand cannot assume that the object remains in place while an external model reasons. Continuing the current skill can expose useful evidence or destabilize the grasp. Slowing every action can reduce movement without supplying the corrective motion needed to recover. A suitable local controller must act on the current contact state even when the next semantic decision is unavailable.

We investigate the following question: *how should a dexterous controller execute a visual agent's current intention while a new decision is pending, and resume useful motion after it arrives?* Our system separates the semantic decision rate from the motor control rate. An asynchronous agent requests inspection, binds a visible target, and updates its command from feedback. A recurrent student maps a goal representation and measured object pose to joint targets. Two compact learned controllers adapt those targets during pending requests and ordinary execution. This design permits a local policy to react without a second expensive reasoning call.

The visual and control interfaces are explicit. We adapt a ViserDex-style RGB-to-pose policy [1] to a continuous semantic goal input while reusing compatible recurrent weights. A fine-tuned local VLM directly predicts a goal vector. The Astra implementation instead emits validated public tool arguments that are mapped to the same goal space. Thus the controller consumes a common representation, but the Astra branch does not expose hidden model embeddings. The distinction makes it possible to compare a strong external agent with a compact learned grounding model without changing the deployed motor interface.

A credible evaluation must distinguish seeing the target, moving toward it, and finishing correctly. We therefore freeze the task mapping, checkpoint identities, stopping path, and physical success rule before the reported evaluation. Each system retains 40 raw trials. Service-related exclusions are applied symmetrically within a comparison and reported alongside the raw counts. Physical reach diagnostics use a separate metric. This avoids attributing a high low-level reach rate to successful semantic reasoning or autonomous stopping.

Our latest cube evaluation gives 35/40 successes for the complete system, 30/40 for the bare fine-tuned VLM, and 17/40 for the bare rule VLM. An independent controller

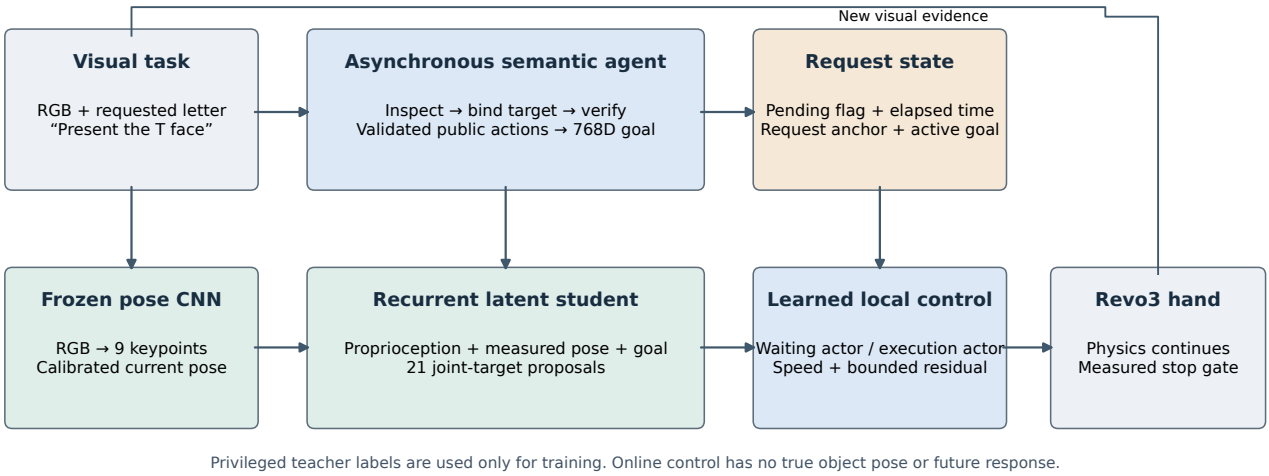


Figure 1. **Continuous control around asynchronous semantic decisions.** The visual agent selects an inspection or target skill. Its validated public command determines a semantic goal vector. A frozen RGB pose estimator and recurrent student run underneath this interface. Separate learned actors adapt joint targets while a request is pending and during execution. The hand continues moving during inference. A common measured-pose gate decides when to stop, and an independent evaluator checks true task completion. The fine-tuned VLM baseline predicts its vector directly and uses the same student without the added actors.

comparison improves the waiting-stage policy while keeping execution and the student fixed. Two complementary interventions examine the agent: removing subsequent feedback sharply reduces completion, and changing the letter–color association exposes a weakness of the fine-tuned grounding baseline. These studies test different mechanisms and are reported as separate cohorts. Earlier results and unsuccessful controller variants remain part of the evidence.

This work develops three contributions: (1) a semantic control interface that connects asynchronous visual decisions to a recurrent dexterous student, (2) teacher-supervised local adaptation that maintains physical execution during reasoning and resumes goal-directed motion afterward, and (3) matched feedback and visual-semantic interventions that separate useful observation, contact failure, and service availability. Current results support the complete system and motivate learned waiting control. They do not establish a benefit from explicit controller-goal conditioning or a stable advantage over the fine-tuned model. Multi-object and hardware validation remain necessary.

2. Related Work

Visual dexterous manipulation. ViserDex uses monocular visual pose estimation and recurrent control for dexterous reorientation, with Gaussian representations supporting visual training [1]. We reuse this division between perception and control and adapt a released Revo3 policy to semantic goals. ManipTrans studies residual learning for dexterous bimanual transfer [4]. These works motivate a reusable motor policy and residual adaptation. Our residual parameterization alone is not a novelty claim. The question here is how a local policy should condition its behavior on the phase and intention of an asynchronous semantic agent.

Language and visual agents. Magma connects multimodal representations to agent actions [10]. VERA translates visual plans into robot actions and includes language-conditioned dexterous in-hand reorientation [5]. Its hand experiments include directional rotation prompts. Consequently, language-guided in-hand rotation is not an unoccupied task category. Our setting emphasizes identifying a requested marked face under occlusion, maintaining contact during external reasoning, and checking a canonical target at autonomous stopping. Those distinctions require direct evidence, rather than a claim of being the first language-controlled hand.

Asynchronous robot policies. Real-time chunk execution [2], online corrections for VLA chunks [8], and latency-aware RL [11] address inference delays through different execution and learning designs. DEFLECT studies delay-robust asynchronous VLAs through temporal counterfactual preferences [12]. LiMA combines sparse semantic intention and asynchronous action generation for dexterous manipulation [3]. These are close methodological references. Our current implementation learns small teacher-supervised controllers around a separate recurrent policy and public semantic tools. A controlled comparison with a generic time-aware residual policy is still needed to show

that the active semantic goal and request anchor add value beyond reactive correction.

3. Task and Evaluation Contract

Semantic target. The current object is a cube with six marked faces. An instruction identifies one letter from $\{T, E, R, L, S, H\}$. Each face has a fixed color and a canonical world orientation $Q(g)$ that places its normal upward. The environment scores the full canonical quaternion, including its fixed twist, rather than accepting every orientation with the correct normal. The language prompt is therefore less specific than the scoring convention. This convention is disclosed and held constant for all methods. A face-normal-only score can be reported as an additional diagnostic without replacing the primary metric.

At step t, the agent observes RGB evidence I_t and the instruction ℓ. The motor system observes proprioception x_t and measured pose $\hat{p}_t$. True pose p_t, teacher actions, and future semantic responses are unavailable to online control. The simulator exposes them only for training labels and independent scoring. We denote the active goal vector by g_t, recurrent state by h_t, and the pending-request flag by m_t.

Physical time. One request may be pending at a time. The default protocol allows six model calls per episode and 3,600 logical control steps at 30 Hz. If a call starts at k and takes L wall-clock seconds, its response becomes usable only after the call completes and at least $\lceil 30L \rceil$ control steps have elapsed. Physics continues throughout this interval. The simulator currently runs slower than real time. This protocol represents inference delay in simulated physical time, but does not demonstrate a 30 Hz hardware pipeline.

Autonomous completion. All systems share a measured-pose stopping gate, evaluated at 3 Hz. It requires a declared binding for the requested symbol, no pending request, a non-inspection state, and measured full-orientation error at most $\epsilon = 0.16$ radians. The gate may stop independently of an agent's native stop suggestion. At stop time τ, the independent success variable is

$$S = \mathbf{1}\left[\hat{b}_\tau = b^*(\ell),\ d(q_\tau, Q(b^*)) \le \epsilon,\ \neg D_{0:\tau}\right], \quad (1)$$

where $\hat{b}_\tau$ is the declared face binding, q_τ is true orientation, $D_{0:\tau}$ indicates an earlier terminal drop, and $d(q, Q) = 2\arccos(|\langle q, Q\rangle|)$ for normalized quaternions. Merely passing through a target does not count. No extra hold duration is added after stopping. A pose false stop and a semantically wrong binding are failures even if the hand retains the object. The frozen drop rule is distance of at least 0.24 metres from the nominal object grasp position.

Matched reporting. Every arm uses 40 raw trials from two seeds, with 20 trials per seed and matching initial physical states and instructions across semantic conditions. A service error or measured model latency above 120 seconds is recorded as a service exclusion. For a panel of methods $\mathcal{C}$, the eligible set removes the union of excluded trial identifiers across $\mathcal{C}$. We report both raw and eligible outcomes, never replace an excluded trial, and never mix denominators from different panels. Long service delays remain visible without being interpreted as controller failures.

4. Method

Figure 1 summarizes AgenticRotation. The system has a semantic interface, a visual motor policy, and local adaptation. The semantic interface changes the active intention. The local controllers change how that intention is executed using current measurements.

4.1. Reusing a visual pose-conditioned student

A frozen CNN predicts the image coordinates and depth of the object center and eight keypoints from a 120×120 RGB image. Calibration, unprojection, and rigid fitting recover $\hat{p}_t \in \mathbb{R}^7$, comprising position and an XYZW quaternion. The fit residual accompanies the measurement. The current rendering uses the object's Gaussian representation with live black hand occlusion. It is not a full-scene image or a real-camera observation, and no ground-truth pose fallback is used at deployment.

The inherited student expects geometric goals. We replace its goal channels with a learned projection of $g_t \in \mathbb{R}^{768}$:

$$z_t = \tanh(W_g g_t + b_g) \in \mathbb{R}^{64}, \quad (2)$$

$$(u_t, h_{t+1}) = \pi_\theta([x_t, z_t], \hat{p}_t, h_t). \quad (3)$$

Here $x_t \in \mathbb{R}^{109}$ contains target-free proprioceptive features and history, while $u_t \in \mathbb{R}^{21}$ gives normalized joint-target proposals. Compatible encoders, recurrent weights, actor weights, and normalization statistics are initialized from the released policy. Neither target quaternion nor relative-goal quaternion is an input to the migrated student.

The first training stage fits the new interface while preserving inherited coefficients. A second stage adapts the recurrent core using actions labeled by the frozen privileged teacher. Teacher and student rollouts are mixed in a DAgger-style procedure [7]. The frozen release uses 200 interface updates and 400 adaptation updates, each with 128 environments and 45 rollout steps, totaling 3,456,000 transitions. These stages use simulated pose noise. All reported closed-loop trials instead obtain pose from the frozen CNN. We separately measure the loss introduced by this transfer rather than assuming that initialization preserves the teacher's performance.

4.2. Semantic grounding and public actions

We maintain six normalized goal vectors $B = \{g_1, \ldots, g_6\}$ from cached SigLIP2 text features [9]. Each vector denotes a color skill and is bound to a canonical orientation in the audited asset. The goal bank is fixed for the cube release.

Astra interface. Astra receives the requested letter and visual observations. It emits a validated public action from `inspect_face`, `reorient_target`, `verify_target`, `stop`, or `abstain`. A color argument selects a vector from B. Inspection can change the motor goal without declaring that the requested letter has been found. Inspection actions can request between 10 and 90 control steps. Subsequent visual evidence and public action history support another decision. We use the name Astra for the hosted route `gpt-6-astra` recorded in our experiment, not for a model trained here. Its exact reproducible provider version is a release requirement.

The vector delivered to the student is a local encoding of a public command. We do not access Astra's internal features, train Astra weights, or describe this pathway as end-to-end language-to-action learning. This explicit interface also enables fixed-public-plan diagnostics in which the motor system is evaluated under recorded decisions and delays.

Fine-tuned VLM. The compact baseline uses Qwen3-VL-4B-Instruct [6] with low-rank adaptation and a goal head. The head predicts a normalized continuous vector in the centered five-dimensional span of B, together with a readability probability. The continuous vector enters Eq. 3 directly. Its nearest canonical vector determines the declared binding and the orientation used by the shared stopping gate. This interface is not unrestricted open-vocabulary motor generation.

Let y indicate whether the requested mark is readable, k its skill index, and $\hat{g}$ the predicted goal. Training combines readability binary cross-entropy with positive-example goal classification and cosine alignment:

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{ground}} = \text{BCE}(\hat{y}, y) + \mathbf{1}[y = 1]\big(\text{CE}(\hat{k}, k) + 1 - \cos(\hat{g}, g_k)\big). \tag{4}$$

The implementation averages positive terms over readable examples. Readability supervision uses geometric visibility and an image-signal filter, not human judgments. Training first uses teacher-view data and then includes observations from student trajectories. The current objective does not include an action-consistency loss.

Rule VLM. The rule baseline parses a color and readability decision from the local VLM and maps accepted colors to B. Both local baselines use the same fixed inspection sequence when a view is not accepted. They use the migrated student directly, with no learned waiting actor, execution actor, or learned completion correction. This is the primary complete-system comparison. A separate auxiliary comparison adds the same control actors to each provider to examine the control contribution.

4.3. Learning control while a request is pending

An outstanding query does not determine whether the current movement is still safe. We construct a deployable feature vector s_t from proprioception, measured pose, student belief, proposed action, pose-fit residual, semantic binding status, and request status. It also includes the measured pose and command at the request anchor and elapsed pending time. The active goal g_t is encoded separately. Before a binding is established it denotes the startup or inspection skill, not the unavailable future target.

A 192-dimensional sensor encoder and 64-dimensional goal encoder feed a 128-dimensional fusion layer. A waiting actor produces one speed logit r_t and a residual $v_t \in \mathbb{R}^{21}$. Let $\bar{q}_t$ be normalized current joint position and $\bar{u}_t$ the clipped student proposal. The applied command is

$$\alpha_t = \text{sigmoid}(4r_t + \text{logit}(0.15)), \tag{5}$$

$$b_t = \begin{cases} \bar{q}_t + \alpha_t(\bar{u}_t - \bar{q}_t), & m_t = 1, \\ \bar{u}_t, & m_t = 0, \end{cases} \tag{6}$$

$$a_t = \text{clip}\big(b_t + 0.35\tanh(v_t), -1, 1\big). \tag{7}$$

Zero outputs reproduce fixed slowing with a coefficient of 0.15 during a pending query. The environment applies its original joint mapping and smoothing. The residual gives the controller a way to correct a holding posture rather than merely suppress movement.

Waiting targets are generated by the frozen teacher with the request anchor as the holding objective. This supervision is available in simulation. The deployed actor receives measurements and the active goal only. It never receives the answer being computed. The objective fits the applied action to the teacher label and penalizes residual magnitude:

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{control}} = \mathbb{E}_{(s,g,a^*)\sim\mathcal{D}}\left[\|a_\phi(s,g) - a^*\|_2^2 + 0.01\|\delta_\phi(s,g)\|_2^2\right]. \tag{8}$$

Refitting the waiting policy. The latest system refits the waiting actor on separately collected measured-state trajectories, using 2,400 updates from the existing actor initialization. Half of each actor batch contains pending states, and the remaining half contains equal numbers of unbound and bound execution states. Pending samples are drawn uniformly. A startup-balanced sampling candidate is also trained under the same budget. A separate fixed-plan development comparison selects the uniform candidate under a prespecified completion/drop rule, followed by fresh

live confirmation. Only its pending-request outputs are deployed. The original execution actor, student, pose predictor, and stopping gate remain fixed. This selection does not use the latest three-system evaluation.

4.4. Learning execution after a decision

A second actor with the same architecture serves non-pending execution. It uses the student proposal as its base, with no speed attenuation, and learns the bounded correction in Eq. 7. Its target is the teacher action for the active goal. It can remain active throughout execution, including inspection, rather than only during a short handover interval.

Paired training examples reuse a physical state and recurrent history with different valid goals. Features and teacher labels are reconstructed for each goal. The motivation is that a generic holding action can preserve contact without moving toward the requested orientation. Goal-dependent labels give the actor a reason to retain directional information. This data construction does not itself demonstrate that the deployed network uses semantics. We test this mechanism with a matched no-explicit-goal actor, shuffled-goal evaluation, and restored-state interventions. The completed tests do not establish a benefit from the explicit actor-goal pathway (Sec. 5).

Training also includes states collected under recorded public action and delay schedules, matching the controller's pending and execution phases more closely to deployment. The selected execution actor is the v6 candidate from development. The same weights are retained throughout the frozen evaluation. The original development selection was informed by observed development outcomes, not a blind preregistration. Reserved evaluation results did not select the checkpoint. Learned completion heads were explored during development but are not active in the reported release.

4.5. Closed-loop execution

At each control step, the system updates visual pose, advances the recurrent student, chooses the waiting or execution actor, and applies the resulting joint targets. A completed semantic response is validated before it changes the active skill or declared binding. The next image reflects the motion that occurred while the previous response was pending. The common stopping gate is checked separately from semantic action generation. Invalid model output cannot supply ground-truth information or silently select the requested target.

This decomposition offers two distinct opportunities for learning. The low-level student can improve physical reach under its actual pose sensor. The controllers can improve how a fixed student handles a pending request or a new intention. These changes must be evaluated separately. Replacing a student changes the controller's belief and proposal distribution, so existing controller weights are checkpoint-bound and cannot be assumed to transfer unchanged.

5. Experiments

We organize evaluation around four questions: **Q1** How do complete systems compare across objects? **Q2** What do local control, semantic evidence, and agent feedback contribute? **Q3** Does improved pose prediction improve completion? **Q4** Do the findings transfer to a physical hand? One cube and the registered Q2 comparisons are complete. Additional objects, predictor improvements, and hardware results remain TODO.

5.1. Setup and reporting

Experiments use Revo3 cube assets in Isaac Lab 3.0/Newton with validated contact capacities. Each condition has two seeds and 40 scheduled trials. Initial physical states are matched within each study. All systems use the same frozen pose estimator, goal bank, latent student, 0.16-radian success threshold, and measured-pose stopping gate. The primary fine-tuned and rule VLM baselines omit the added waiting and execution actors. Astra uses adaptive inspection, whereas the local baselines use a fixed unreadable-view schedule. This is a comparison of complete systems, with natural model latencies, rather than an isolated test of model weights.

The latest Astra system replaces only its waiting actor. Earlier release cohorts, module interventions, and fixed-public-plan development tests are kept separate. Table percentages use common service-eligible trials within the stated comparison. All raw records are retained, and no failed or excluded slot is replaced. Wilson intervals describe individual rates. Paired tests are exploratory and unadjusted except for the six registered visual contrasts, which use Holm correction.

5.2. Q1: Complete systems and object coverage

The latest full Astra system succeeds in 35/40 trials (87.5%), compared with 30/40 (75.0%) for the bare fine-tuned VLM and 17/40 (42.5%) for the bare rule VLM (Table 1). Astra has nine exclusive successes against four for the fine-tuned VLM, giving exact paired $p = 0.267$. The 12.5-point difference is therefore a favorable estimate, not established superiority. Against the rule VLM, the corresponding counts are twenty and two ($p = 0.000121$).

Earlier cohorts are retained. The original release gives 29/39, 26/39, and 13/39 eligible successes for Astra, fine-tuned VLM, and rule VLM. An independent replication with that release gives 26/37, 27/37, and 21/37. Neither

System	Successes	Rate (%)	95% Wilson interval	Drops	Model calls
Astra full	35/40	87.5	[73.9, 94.5]	3	101
Fine-tuned VLM, bare	30/40	75.0	[59.8, 85.8]	9	117
Rule VLM, bare	17/40	42.5	[28.5, 57.8]	12	126

Table 1. **Q1: latest native-image cube comparison.** Each system has 40 matched trials, with no service exclusions. Astra uses refitted waiting control and the original execution actor. The two VLM baselines use the shared student without these actors. Model calls total all 40 trials. This evaluation uses the original object/hand RGB pipeline, not the reconstructed images used for the separate semantic intervention.

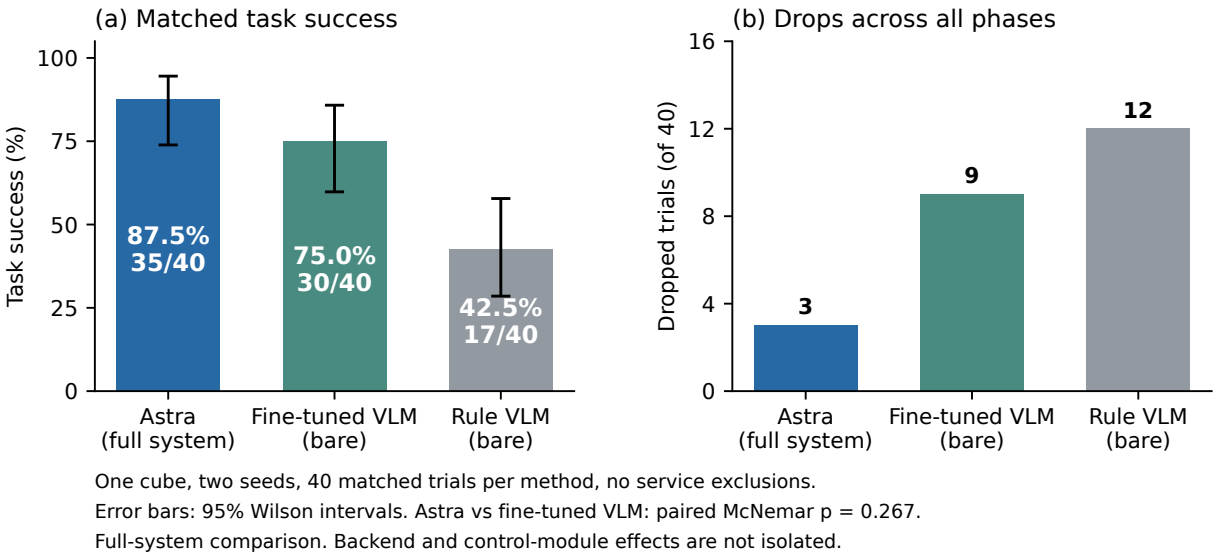


Figure 2. **Latest complete-system outcomes.** Success requires correct semantic binding and true orientation within tolerance at autonomous stop. The bars show individual 95% Wilson intervals. Astra records three drops, the fine-tuned baseline nine, and the rule baseline twelve. Both completion and contact failure are reported on the same 40-trial panel.

establishes Astra superiority over fine-tuning. The latest cohort uses new seeds and a refitted waiting actor, so its increase cannot be assigned entirely to that actor. The dedicated waiting comparison below provides a more controlled estimate. The supplement retains the original factorial and shared-controller VLM comparisons. We do not pool these versions or discard unfavorable cohorts.

Remaining failures. All three latest Astra drops occur during unbound inspection, outside pending requests. One further trial binds the requested letter to the wrong color and stops, and one abstains before binding. No waiting-stage drop occurs in this cohort, although one occurs with the refitted actor in the separate waiting study. The three inspection failures motivate contact-stable evidence acquisition. Their proximity to an inspection command does not establish its causal role. Success among trials that reach correct binding is not an unconditional measure of student reliability.

The bare fine-tuned VLM has nine execution drops and one horizon failure. The bare rule VLM has twelve drops, ten false stops, and one horizon failure. Median call latencies are 4.35 seconds for Astra, 0.099 seconds for fine-tuning, and 1.10 seconds for the rule baseline. The timing audit verifies continued control through pending intervals and delayed application of replies. It does not establish real-time simulator throughput.

5.3. Q2: Local control and agent mechanisms

Waiting control. A live Astra comparison changes only the waiting actor, keeping the original execution actor, student, and stopping gate fixed. One service-affected slot is removed from both arms, leaving 39 matched trials (Table 3). Refitting gives six additional successes and five fewer drops. Original waiting has two startup drops, two later waiting drops, and six execution drops. Refitted waiting has no startup drops, one later waiting drop, and four execution drops. There are eight refit-only successes and two original-

Simulation object	Rule	Fine-tuned	Full
Cube, latest release	17/40	30/40	35/40
Object 2	TODO	TODO	TODO
Object 3	TODO	TODO	TODO
Object 4	TODO	TODO	TODO
Object 5	TODO	TODO	TODO

Table 2. **Q1: object coverage.** Only the cube row is measured. Further objects require recorded geometry, calibration, policy, goal definitions, and 40 matched trials per method. Object-specific students do not imply zero-shot transfer. No average is computed over unfinished rows.

Waiting policy	Eligible	Rate (%)	Drops	Raw
Original waiting	27/39	69.2	10	28/40
Refitted waiting	33/39	84.6	5	33/40

Table 3. **Q2: independent waiting comparison.** Eligible success and drops use the common 39-trial panel. Raw gives successes from all 40 slots. The excluded refit trial is a service failure, not a recorded drop.

only successes ($p = 0.109$). Thus the independent estimate improves both completion and stability, without resolving a statistically reliable effect at this sample size.

Execution and goal dependence. The original waiting–execution factorial gives 20/37 successes with fixed slowing and the unmodified student, 25/37 with waiting only, 26/37 with execution only, and 27/37 with both. Full versus fixed control has $p = 0.210$, and full versus execution only has $p = 1.0$. These historical results do not establish a reliable interaction.

The completed goal-input intervention gives 25/36 successes with the correct explicit controller goal, 24/36 with a retrained no-explicit-goal controller, and 30/36 with shuffled controller goals. The student retains its assigned goal in all conditions. A restored-state diagnostic likewise gives 26/38 final in-tolerance branches with explicit actor goals versus 29/38 without them, over 19 valid states and two goals per state. These outcomes do not support a useful explicit actor-goal pathway. We retain the negative result rather than selecting the shuffled variant after evaluation.

A separate 160-trial fixed-plan development test evaluates a learned gate on the original execution residual. Original execution succeeds in 29/40 trials, fixed gating in 27/40, phase-fixed gating in 24/40, and learned gating in 26/40. The learned candidate also increases drops from three to five and fails its admission rule. It is not deployed in Table 1. This replay experiment makes no new Astra calls and is not a live agent success estimate.

Protocol	Eligible success	Rate (%)	Calls
One initial plan	7/39	17.9	40
Full feedback	30/39	76.9	113

Table 4. **Q2: initial plan versus full feedback.** Calls total 40 raw episodes. The protocols have different inference budgets. The comparison measures their overall value, not a feedback effect under equal compute.

System	Identity	Permuted	Masked
Astra full	32/40	32/40	0/39
Fine-tuned VLM, bare	30/40	16/40	3/40
Rule VLM, bare	23/40	23/40	0/40

Table 5. **Q2: visual-semantic evidence.** Identity and permutation retain all 40 trials. Astra masking has one service exclusion. Its paired masking contrast uses 31/39 identity successes versus 0/39 masked successes. The local methods have no exclusions. This study uses the original Astra actors.

Value of feedback. The same-Astra comparison holds the student, original actors, stopping gate, and horizon fixed. One condition receives a single initial bounded plan. The other allows up to six calls using subsequent observations and history. A common service exclusion leaves 39 trials per arm.

Feedback gives 24 exclusive successes against one for the initial plan ($p = 1.55 \times 10^{-6}$). Seventeen trials change from initial-plan abstention to feedback success. No wrong-to-correct binding transition is observed in this cohort, so the result supports continued evidence acquisition and decision-making without establishing semantic error correction. Raw success is 7/40 versus 31/40, and drops are six versus nine. A protocol that often abstains early has fewer opportunities to drop, which makes completion essential alongside drop counts.

Visual-semantic intervention. We keep predictor input and lighting fixed while changing the upper-level image. Identity, one cyclic letter–color permutation, and letter masking are evaluated on 40 matched states per method. All three conditions use geometry-consistent reconstructed face images, including identity. Consequently, this is a controlled image benchmark rather than the untouched RGB main comparison.

Astra retains 32/40 successes after permutation, while fine-tuned success falls from 30/40 to 16/40 (Holm-adjusted $p = 0.0130$ across six planned contrasts). Rule success remains 23/40. Equal aggregate rates do not establish equivalence or identical trajectories. Masking removes almost all completion, supporting dependence on visible semantic evidence. Nine of eleven fine-tuned wrong-binding trials af-

ter permutation select the original letter–color association. This is consistent with reliance on learned associations, but does not identify an exclusive memorization mechanism. One cube and one permutation do not establish broad semantic generalization.

5.4. Q3: Visual pose prediction

The frozen physical diagnostic uses the same CNN for both students. The released pose-goal policy reaches before dropping in 39/40 trials, versus 35/40 for the latent student. A separate matched development study gives reach counts of 39/40 for the released student, 38/40 for the frozen latent student, 39/40 after additional simulated-noise DAgger, and 40/40 after CNN-feedback DAgger. These 160 trials concern physical reach, not autonomous semantic success. They adapt the student without changing the predictor. The successor is not used in the main comparison.

[TODO: Insert the colleague-provided predictor study.] Compare independent translation and rotation errors, then 40 matched closed-loop trials per predictor with the student, agent, and controllers fixed. Any subsequent policy adaptation is a separate stage. An oracle-pose diagnostic can estimate remaining motor limitations but is not deployable. Existing student training cannot establish a predictor improvement or a hardware advantage over ViserDex.

5.5. Q4: Physical-hand evaluation

[TODO: Add hardware setup, object dimensions and masses, calibration, control frequency, per-object success, timing, and failures.] Use the same hand, camera, reset procedure, instructions, and stopping rule for each system. We plan 40 trials per system and object, split across two sessions. An independent orientation reference must certify completion. Synchronized video, joint commands, requests, responses, and termination events should expose both successes and failures. A key waiting-control comparison on hardware is needed to test whether the simulated contact benefit transfers.

6. Discussion and Limitations

The current evidence connects three parts of an agentic manipulation problem: obtaining semantic evidence through action, preserving contact during delayed reasoning, and completing the grounded target. Feedback substantially improves completion over one initial plan. Refitted waiting improves the observed completion/drop trade-off in an independent comparison. The latest complete system reaches 87.5% on the cube. Its difference from fine-tuning and the waiting gain remain statistically unresolved. Earlier cohorts do not support a universal provider ranking.

Explicit controller-goal conditioning does not improve the matched goal intervention or the restored-state diagnostic. A learned execution gate also fails its development criterion and is not deployed. These findings restrict the learning claim to measured controller behavior. They do not support treating every added module as necessary or attributing observed action differences to a useful semantic recovery representation.

The visual intervention uses reconstructed faces, one permutation, and a single cube. The native perception pipeline renders a Gaussian object with hand occlusion. Neither establishes real-camera robustness. The feedback protocols have unequal call budgets, and the main baselines differ in controller access and inspection scheduling. Hosted model revisions introduce further replication limits. More objects, independent predictor measurements, and physical-hand trials remain open. No safety guarantee, zero-shot object transfer, or broad superiority claim follows from the present study.

7. Conclusion

We presented a pose-mediated semantic reorientation system that maintains local control around asynchronous visual decisions. Completed cube experiments show the value of continued feedback, expose sensitivity to visual-semantic remapping, and provide a favorable independent estimate for learned waiting control. Remaining failures concentrate on inspection before target binding. The current results motivate contact-stable evidence acquisition while preserving negative goal and execution ablations. Multi-object and hardware studies will test how far these findings transfer.

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LLM Usage Statement

Generative AI tools assisted with research discussion, implementation, experiment orchestration, literature retrieval, data analysis, and manuscript drafting. Astra and Qwen3-VL are also components evaluated in the research. Numerical results in this draft are derived from recorded experiments. Unfinished experiments are explicitly marked TODO. The authors must verify the final text, references, code, and results and remain responsible for the submitted work.